

Mark Smalley

Chief Technology Officer · Blockchain Protocol Architect · Engineering Leader

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Fireblocks

Re: Solution Architect, EMEA

I am writing to apply for the Solution Architect, EMEA role at Fireblocks. My background is 15 years building production digital asset infrastructure: custody systems, wallet architecture, tokenisation platforms, and protocol-level cryptography. I have delivered end-to-end implementations for institutional clients across multiple jurisdictions, from initial architecture through to production deployment.

Specific evidence mapped to your requirements:

- ▶ **Experience with blockchain, cryptography, or Web3 technologies, AND Banks, Financial Institutions, or enterprise financial systems:** Co-founded CoKeeps, now Malaysia's largest Digital Asset Custodian by AUM. Built the complete custody stack from first principles: multi-signature wallet infrastructure, key management, role-based access controls, transaction signing orchestration. First blockchain company admitted to the Securities Commission Malaysia regulatory sandbox.
- ▶ **Post-sales implementation delivery in complex enterprise or financial settings:** 13 years operating a blockchain consultancy delivering to institutional clients across banking, securities regulation, and digital asset custody. 5-day intensive advisory engagement with Baker Hostetler (US law firm) on digital asset custody frameworks. Translated technical architecture into compliance-ready documentation for institutional stakeholders.
- ▶ **Deep understanding of IT security and cloud platform proficiency:** Designed and built the SADO Protocol (decentralised order-book using PSBTs on Bitcoin). Hands-on with UTXO scripting, Schnorr/Taproot multi-signature schemes, atomic swap patterns, passkey/WebAuthN/FIDO2 cryptographic key management. Production deployments on Cloudflare Workers, Docker, CI/CD pipelines.
- ▶ **Software development background with hands-on technical capabilities:** Led the Ordzaar SDK architecture (ordinals/inscriptions tooling) that spun out of CakeDefi, raised US\$500K, and was acquired. Designed API interfaces, integration documentation, and developer onboarding. Currently shipping 83 AI-callable MCP tools and Consumer SDKs serving 1M+ requests per week.
- ▶ **Strong knowledge of enterprise architecture and best practices:** Designed extensible plugin architecture that scaled from single product to multi-product ecosystem without core rewrites. Four-layer separation (Rules, Engine, Tools, Web) where each layer is independently deployable with its own subdomain. Same architectural discipline applied to custody and tokenisation systems at CoKeeps.
- ▶ **Technical leadership experience mentoring technical teams:** Founded and grew CakeDefi's Moonshot team from 1 to 10 engineers in 7 months: hiring, sprint cadence, product vision, and stakeholder reporting. Led cross-functional delivery at Neuroware for 13 years. Comfortable serving as liaison between Sales, Product, R&D, and client teams.

My differentiator is that I have built the systems Fireblocks abstracts. Understanding custody, key management, and settlement at the implementation level means I can architect solutions for enterprise clients that account for edge cases, security boundaries, and regulatory constraints that surface-level knowledge would miss. I have navigated integrations spanning banking infrastructure, asset custody, tokenisation, and regulatory compliance across four countries.

I am based in the UK, immediately available, and hold British citizenship (no sponsorship required). I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience building institutional digital asset infrastructure can contribute to Fireblocks' enterprise deployments across EMEA.

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